

OLM Open Tools OLM Radial Blur User Manual

OLM Digital, Inc.

Table of Contents

1. Introduction	4
1.1. Supported Environment	4
1.2. Install	4
2. Using OLM Radial Blur	4
3. OLM Radial Blur parameters	4
4. Other	9

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Change Logs

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Figure. 4, 9, 10

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Figure. 1, 5, 8, 11

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1. Introduction

OLM Radial Blur is an After Effects plug-in which can apply a special zoom/rotation blur. Unlike normal zoom/rotation blur, it's anisotropic. Zoom blur blurs towards/outwards center with different strength. Rotation blur blurs clockwise/counterclockwise with different strength. Both blur ignore fully transparent pixels and enable cartoon like motion blurs.

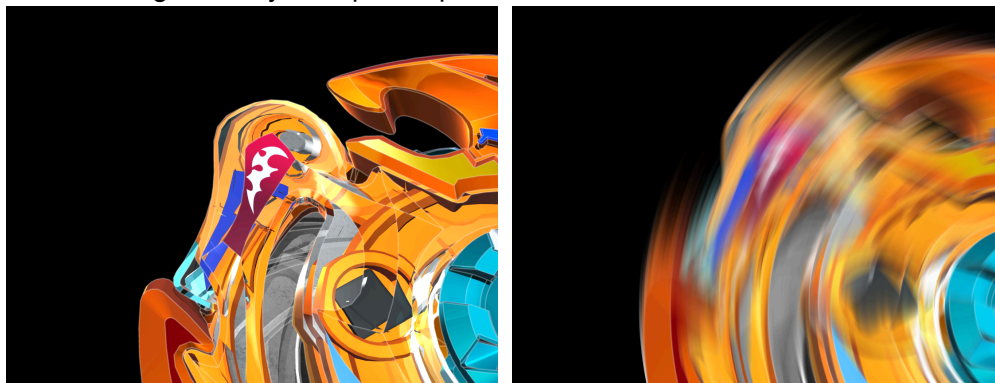


Fig1. (Left) Original image, (Right) After OLM Radial Blur

1.1. Supported Environment

Please refer to OLM Open Tools [website](#) for a complete list of supported environment.

1.2. Install

The zip archive you can download from OLM OpenTools web site contains the files listed in Table 1. To install OLM Directional Blur copy the plug-in file (OLM Radial Blur.aex) in A E plug-in directory

(example : C:\Program Files\Adobe\Adobe After Effects 2022\Support Files\Plug-ins\OLM)

Folder	File Name	Explanation
Plugins\64\[Version]	OLM Radial Blur.aex	The plug-in files.
Doc	OLM Radial Blur UserManual.pdf	The user manual for OLM Radial Blur

Table 1 : Content of the zip archive

After Effects plugins from OLM Open Tools use Visual C++ 2019 runtime. They require the installation of Visual C++ Redistributable that supports Visual C++2019. After Effects usually ships with a compatible version, but if the plugin does not work please install the [latest Visual C++ Redistributable](#) yourself.

2. Using OLM Radial Blur

To apply the effect, use the menu: (Effects)→(OLM Plug-ins)→(OLM Radial Blur)

3. OLM Radial Blur parameters

OLM Radial Blur parameters are as follows.

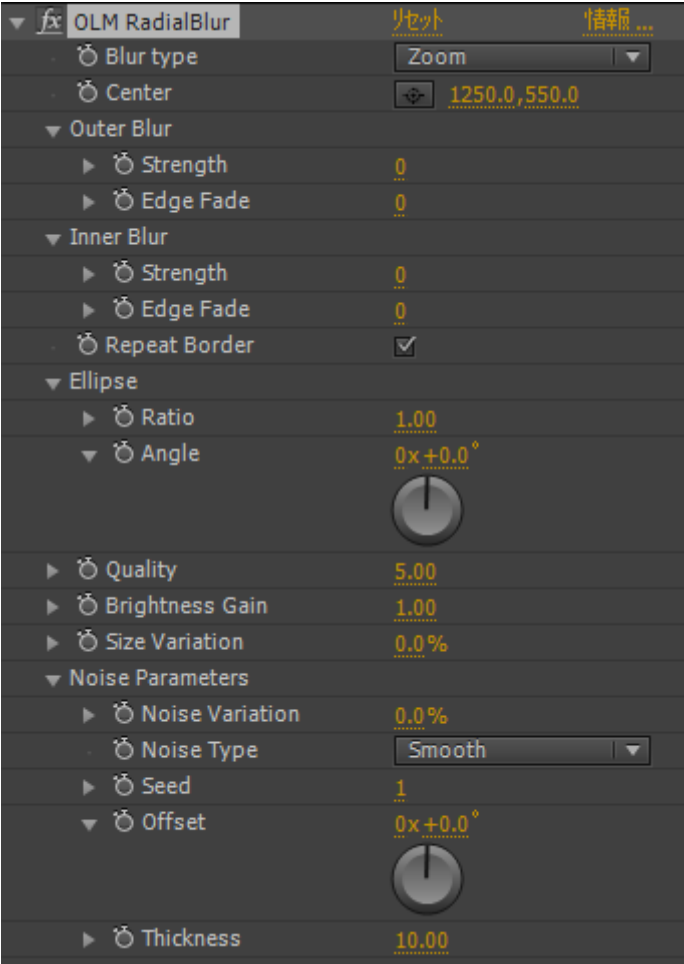


Fig. 2 OLM Radial Blur parameters

1. **Blur Type** – A set of parameters to control the blur type.

Rotation – Applies rotation blur.

Zoom – Applies zoom blur.

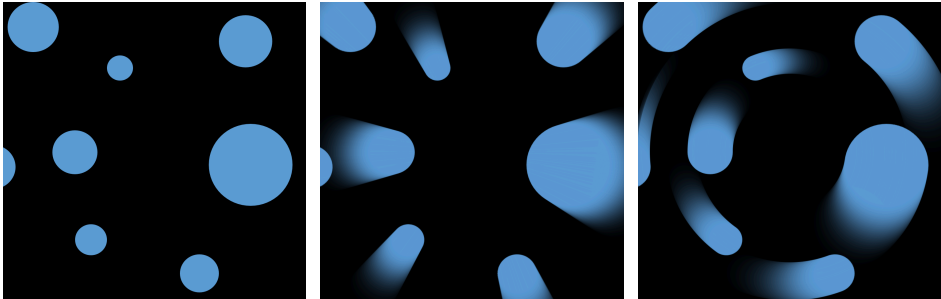


Fig. 3 Type of blur (Left) Original image, (Middle) Zoom, (Right)Rotation

2. **Center** – Center point of zoom/rotation.
3. **Outer (Inner) Blur** – The parameters of blur. Outer is for outward/clockwise direction,

and Inner is for inward/counterclockwise direction.

- i. **Strength** - Determines the strength of the blur. Value go from 0 to 800 pixels.
- ii. **Edge Fade** – Generates fade-in on the inner (outer) side. Value go from 0 to100. The fade-in region is synchronized with the size variation parameter.

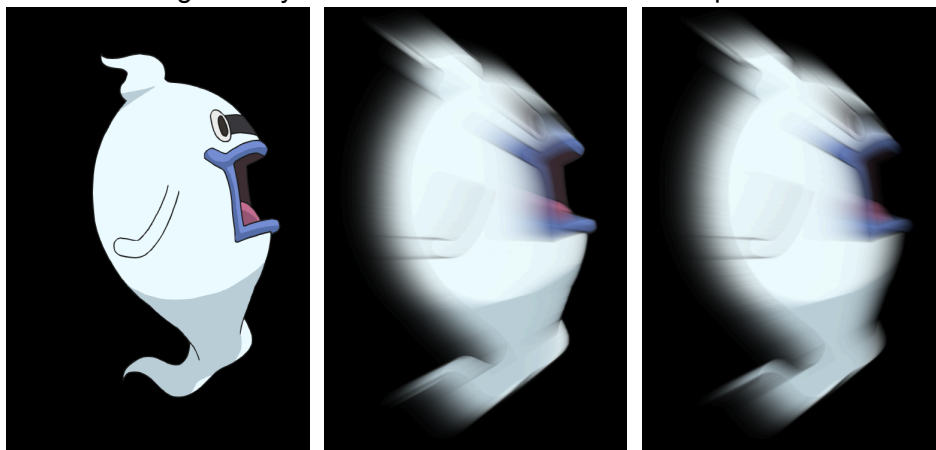


Fig. 4 (Left) Original image, (Middle) Alpha Fade=0, (Right) Alpha Fade=100

4. **Repeat Border** – Prevents fading at image boundaries as shown in Fig. 5. Such fading occurs only when “Edge Fade” is used.



Fig.5 The effect of “Repeat Border” (Left) Off, (Right) On

5. **Ellipse** – A set of parameters to transform the circle of radial blur in an ellipse.
 - i. **Ratio** – A ratio of major axis to minor axis of base ellipse. Value go from 0.0 to 5.0.
 - ii. **Angle** – An angle of major axis of base ellipse.

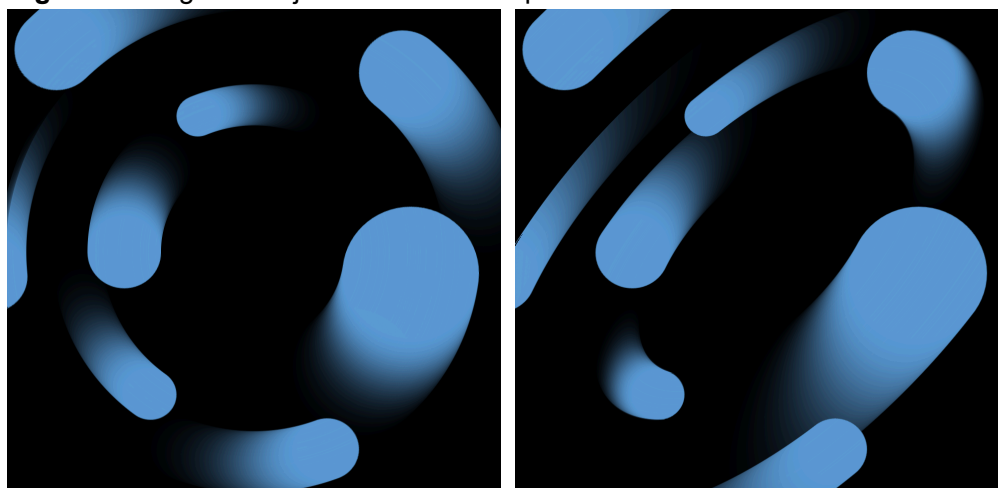


Fig. 6 Ellipse (Left) Ratio=1.0, Angle=0°, (Right) Ratio=2.0, Angle=45°

6. **Quality** – Quality of the transformation to ellipse. Smaller value results in faster computation but less quality for pixels far from the center. Value go from 1.0 to 50.0.
7. **Brightness Gain** - Controls the brightness of result image.
8. **Size Variation** - Parameter to change the blur strength according to the size of each pixel group (opaque pixels). Overlapping group of pixels are considered as one group. Value go from 0 (no variation) to 100 (the smallest group will have no blur applied). This parameter will determine the size of the region Alpha fade occurs.

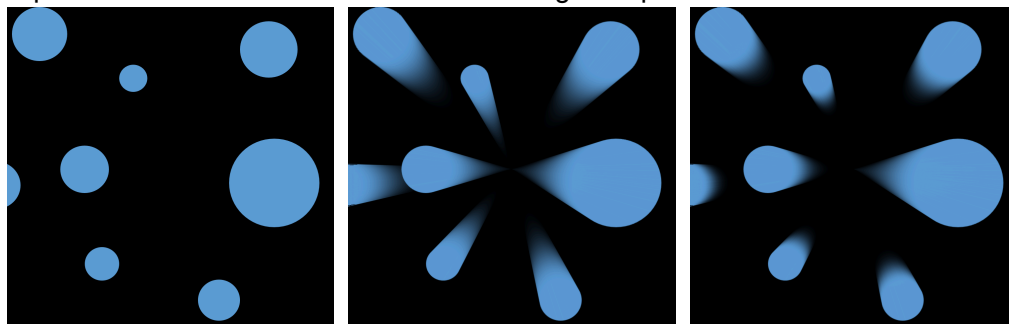


Fig. 7 (Left) Original image, (Middle) Size Variation=0, (Right) Size Variation=70

9. **Noise Parameters** - The parameters to add per pixel variation in blur strength. By adjusting these parameters, jagged blur as shown in fig.6 can be generated.
 - i. **Noise Variation** - Controls the amount of noise. Value go from 0 to 100.

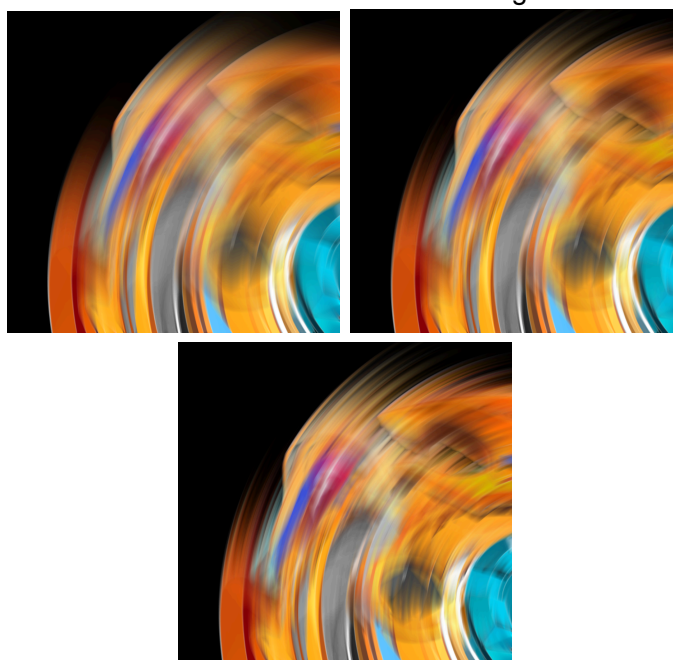


Fig. 8 (Left) Noise Variation=0, (Middle) Noise Variation=50, (Right) Noise Variation=100

- ii. **Noise Type** - A set of parameters to control the noise type.

Smooth – Adds smooth noise.

Block – Adds block noise.



Fig. 9 Difference between “Smooth” and “Block”. (Left) Smooth, (Right) Block

Layer - Uses user defined noise. The noise is given as layer, the brighter the noise layer pixel, the bigger the blur strength. Noise layer should be same size as the layer applied “OLM Radial Blur”. Don’t forget to pre-compose a layer if you want its effects, translation/scaling... to be considered.

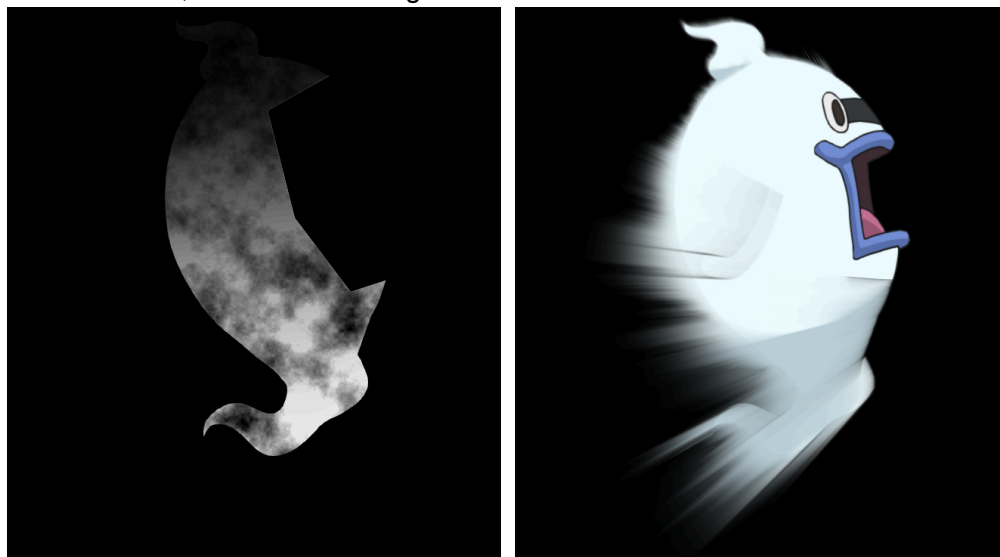


Fig. 10 Layer noise (Left) referenced layer, (Right) result

- iii. **Seed** - A random seed used for noise generation. It changes the noise pattern. It’s valid only when “Noise Type” is “Smooth” or “Block”.
- iv. **Offset** - Can be animated to change noise pattern smoothly. It’s valid only when “Noise Type” is “Smooth” or “Block”.
- v. **Thickness** - Controls the frequency of noise as shown in fig. 9. It’s valid only when “Noise Type” is “Smooth” or “Block”. Value go from 1.0 to100.



Fig. 11 (Left) Thickness=5, (Middle) Thickness=15, (Right) Thickness=30

- vi. **Noise Layer** - The layer used as noise. It's valid only when "Noise Type" is "Layer".

4. Other

If you find a bug, have a feature request, or for any kind of feedback feel free to contact us at the following mail address:
opentools@olm.co.jp